

Smart EPP Case Study — Full Audit Report

Audited by: Claude (UX Designer + Recruiter lens) **Date:** June 2026 **File:**

`src/pages/SmartEPPCaseStudy.tsx`

Executive Summary

The case study is genuinely strong in its bones — real research data, honest reflection on failures, good visual hierarchy, and a compelling product story. But it has a structural obesity problem: **12 distinct content areas**, many repeating the same information in different containers. A recruiter spending 3–5 minutes on this page will hit fatigue before reaching the best parts. The cuts below are about signal-to-noise, not about removing quality.

Overall Verdict: Sections 01–06 are excellent. Sections 07–08 are good. Sections 11–12 at the bottom are the weakest and should be cut or rebuilt.

Section-by-Section Breakdown

01. INTRO & STATS

Status: Strong — Minor cleanup needed

The headline — *"Up to 40% of that phone is just tax. We built the system that gives it back."* — is the best line on the page. Keep it exactly as-is.

Issues:

- The 6-cell stats grid (MY ROLE, I WORKED WITH, PLATFORMS, TIMELINE, USER RESEARCH, DESIGN SYSTEM) has an **inconsistent label convention**. "MY ROLE" and "I WORKED WITH" are first-person. "PLATFORMS", "TIMELINE", "USER RESEARCH", "DESIGN SYSTEM" are category labels. Pick one format for all 6.
- "DESIGN SYSTEM: 44 components" contradicts the Problem section which says the design system was **"Existing — Built on OneAssist's library."** This will confuse a recruiter: did you build 44 components from scratch, or did you

extend an existing library? Clarify: *"44 components built on OneAssist's existing design system."*

- The "I WORKED WITH" cell lists team members across two lines. This cell shape is awkward at narrower widths. Consider moving team info to a single line or removing it — recruiters care about *your* contribution, not the team size.

02. THE PROBLEM

Status: Strong core, redundant scope grid

The 5-challenge cards are sharp. "The Hardest One" full-width card is excellent.

Issues:

- **Project Scope grid is redundant with the Intro stats grid.** It repeats: 4 platforms, 5-month timeline, design system, 4 user types. You've already said all of this above. Cut this scope grid entirely. The narrative paragraphs on the left already tell the story better.
- "Why now: a 2023–24 tax change unlocked the savings. 30% income-tax relief plus 18% GST nets ~40% after financier interest." This sentence is great but appears in the secondary paragraph where skimmers miss it. It should be a callout — this is the *why* behind the entire product.

03. RESEARCH

Status: Good — One image bug, one misleading stat

Issues:

- **All 3 "The Fix" screenshots point to the same image** (</images/smart-epp-calculator-screen.png>). Card 1 (Employee Confusion) showing the calculator makes sense. Card 2 (Employee Anxiety, about trust signals) and Card 3 (HR Friction, about the approval dashboard) both show the calculator screen. This is wrong. A recruiter clicking the HR card thumbnail to see the "Single-row approval dashboard" will see a calculator. Fix the images or remove the thumbnails from cards 2 and 3.
- The stat "8/12 flagged salary EMIs as their top fear" is a fragment of a 12-person subset. The stats grid earlier says "26 interviews across all 4 actor types." If you did 26 interviews, explain how you get from 26 to 12 employees. Otherwise it looks like you cherry-picked a smaller sample for a better-looking fraction.

04. PROBLEM REFRAME

Status: Low impact — Cut or compress

This section ("Stop designing 4 products. Design 1 system.") takes up a full section with 160px padding to show a visual diagram of: 4 boxes → 1 shared database → 4 views. This is a conceptual point that could be one paragraph inside the Problem section.

The most valuable thing in this section is buried at the very bottom: *"Designing this shared data model first cut design time by ~30%."* This is a concrete outcome — it should be a metric in the Outcomes section, not a footnote in a standalone section.

Recommendation: Delete the entire section. Move the data model insight as a bullet into the Reflection section under "System before screens." Move the "30% less design time" into the Outcomes metrics grid.

05. DESIGN EXPLORATION

Status: Strong section — One misleading claim

The 5-principle bento grid is the best-executed layout on the page. Sharp copy, good visual rhythm.

Issues:

- **"The Winning Formula: 2.4x Higher Conversion"** — The subheading promises 2.4x, and the comparison shows 68% (winner) vs 28% (minimal PDP). $68 \div 28 = 2.43x$ — technically correct. But the Guided Wizard card below it shows "44% Drop-off", not a conversion rate. These are **different metrics** being visually compared side-by-side. A recruiter will read this as "3 concepts were tested, winner beat all others by 2.4x" — which isn't what happened. The 44% drop-off number is a *drop-off rate*, not a conversion rate. Rename the Guided Wizard metric to make it apples-to-apples, or explain that the 2.4x is against the Minimal PDP only.
 - The A/B results here (68%, 28%) are **repeated in Section 07 Outcomes** (68% PDP-to-cart conversion). This is the most repeated single metric on the page. Show it once where it has the most impact — Outcomes.
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06. FINAL SOLUTION (THE 4-TAB PORTAL SHOWCASE)

Status: Best section on the page — Layout bug

The tab-switching between Employee/HR/Financier/Seller portal mockups is smart and efficient. The CSS mockup table for HR is genuinely impressive as a portfolio

artifact.

Issues:

- **Grid/Carousel toggle for the Employee tab adds decision fatigue.** The user must choose between "Carousel" and "Grid View" before seeing any screens. Recruiters don't want another choice — just show the screens. Default to a sensible grid at desktop width and remove the toggle.
 - **System Foundations block** (below the tab section) is 4 cards: title, Design System, Accessibility, Edge Cases. "Inclusive by Design. High-contrast text and large touch targets ensure a frictionless experience." This is so generic it adds nothing. Every product claims this. If you have a specific WCAG metric or screen reader test result, use it. Otherwise cut the Accessibility card entirely.
 - The "Edge Cases: Zero Dead Ends" card shows only 2 edge cases (HR Rejections, Out of Stock). This is underwhelming for a complex 4-party system with 15+ order states. Either show more real edge cases, or cut this card and reference edge case thinking in the Reflection section (which already exists).
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07. VALIDATION (SECTION 06 LABEL)

Status: Good — Heavily overlaps with Outcomes

Issues:

- The 3 metric cards here (11/14 savings recall, 11sec HR approval, -60% anxiety) are essentially **previews of the Outcomes metrics**. 11/14 and "<12s" appear again word-for-word in Section 07 Outcomes. The section exists to show testing methodology, but it reads like a duplicate of the results.
 - **Recommendation:** This section is doing the job of two things: (a) demonstrating testing process and (b) showing metrics. Keep only the process story here — the quote, the Key Pivot (users ignored the standalone "How it works" page), and the "What we missed" paragraph. Move all metric numbers to the Outcomes section. This creates a clean storyline: *Research → Design → Build → Test (how we did it) → Outcomes (what happened)*.
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08. OUTCOMES & IMPACT (SECTION 07 LABEL)

Status: Strong — Over-attributed, one misleading frame

Issues:

- **The Attribution Note is honest and earns credibility.** Keep it. It's rare to see a candidate acknowledge that a 68% conversion was influenced by novelty. Recruiters respect this.

- **"5 mo / MVP to launch" as an outcome metric is redundant.** This is already in the intro stats. Cut it from the outcomes grid — it's a timeline fact, not an outcome.
- **"0% HR program abandonment"** is a great metric but needs clarification: does this mean 0 enterprise clients churned the program? State it more precisely: *"0 enterprise clients churned in the 90 days post-launch."* Otherwise it sounds like a misleading absolute.
- **Success criteria card and Qualitative wins card are duplicative.** The Qualitative Wins card mentions "Support tickets: 'How do I calculate savings?' queries dropped to near-zero." The Success Criteria card shows "Employee cart conversion $\geq$ 50% → Hit (68%)." These are two sides of the same story but rendered as visually equal cards that feel like padding. Merge them.

09. REFLECTION (SECTION 08 LABEL)

Status: Strongest section for a recruiter — One cleanup needed

The reflection grid is genuinely impressive: 4 concrete mistakes, the "edge cases are the product" insight, and a forward-looking "Next Iteration" card. This demonstrates senior designer maturity.

Issues:

- **"The Next Iteration" card reads like a list rather than a reflection.** It lists 3 items: power-user calculator, end-of-tenure flow, redesign of lessor/seller. This is product backlog, not reflection. Reframe: explain *why* you'd prioritize these, what constraints blocked them, or what you learned that led you here.
- This section is the most under-promoted. It's buried after 7+ sections of increasingly heavy content. A recruiter who doesn't make it here misses the best demonstration of your design maturity.

10. DESIGN SYSTEM & ASSETS (SECTION 11)

Status: Cut immediately

This section shows: 3 color swatches (Obsidian, Action Red, Primary Text), 2 typography specimens (Syne, JetBrains Mono), and two non-functional buttons: **"View Pitch Deck (PDF)"** and **"View Figma File."**

These buttons have no `href`, no `onClick` handler that navigates anywhere. They are dead UI. A recruiter who clicks either of these will think the portfolio is broken.

This section actively hurts you. Either wire up the Figma link (even a read-only view) or delete the entire section. A color swatch and two broken buttons add no

design credibility.

11. FINAL THOUGHTS (SECTION 12)

Status: Cut or rewrite

The closing card contains:

- An icon (Target)
- A third-person self-congratulatory quote: *"Smart EPP was a masterclass in designing for trust and low friction over pure aesthetics."*
- A pill: *"Built with: Figma, Claude, & UX Pilot"*
- A "Back to All Projects" button

Issues:

- The quote is written in third-person about your own work. It reads like a press release, not a designer's voice. The word "masterclass" is self-congratulatory and undermines the honest, grounded tone of the Reflection section.
- **"Built with: Figma, Claude, & UX Pilot"** — mentioning AI tools (Claude) in a UX portfolio case study will raise a red flag for many hiring managers. It's the equivalent of putting "Used Grammarly" in a writing portfolio. Remove this entirely.
- The "Back to All Projects" button is the only navigation at the bottom. It works, but the section around it adds no value. Cut the section; keep only the navigation button, styled simply, as a footer element.

Replacement suggestion: End with the Reflection section. Add a single centered "Next Project →" button. The reflection is a far stronger closing signal than a generic quote.

Redundancy Map (Quick Reference)

Content	Where it appears
Platforms: 4 (iOS, Android, Web)	Intro stats grid + Problem scope grid
Timeline: 5 months	Intro stats grid + Problem scope grid + Outcomes grid
Design system	Intro stats grid + Problem scope grid + System Foundations block
68% conversion	Design Exploration A/B + Outcomes metrics
<12s HR approval	Research card label + Validation metric card + Outcomes metric card
11/14 savings recall	Validation metric card + Outcomes metric card
"4 user types, 1 shared flow"	Intro description + Problem scope grid + Problem Reframe section

Misleading / Accuracy Issues

Issue	Location	Fix
"44 components" vs "Existing — Built on OneAssist's library"	Stats grid vs Problem scope grid	Clarify: 44 new components built on top of OneAssist's base
HR Friction card thumbnail shows a calculator, not the HR approval screen	Research Section, Card 3	Replace image with actual HR dashboard screenshot
"2.4x Higher Conversion" compares conversion % to drop-off %	Design Exploration	Use consistent metric types or remove the Guided Wizard comparison
"8/12 flagged salary EMIs" while headline says 26 interviews	Research Section	Clarify that 12 were the employee-specific subset of the 26 total
Dead buttons "View Pitch Deck" and "View Figma File"	Section 11	Remove or wire them up
"Built with Claude"	Section 12 Final Thoughts	Remove entirely

Priority Cut List (Highest to Lowest Impact)

CUT IMMEDIATELY

- Section 11 (Design System & Assets)** — Dead buttons, no value, actively damages credibility
- Section 12 "Final Thoughts" card** — Self-congratulatory quote + AI tool disclosure. Keep only the Back button
- Problem Scope Grid inside Section 02** — Entirely redundant with Intro stats
- Grid/Carousel toggle in Final Solution** — Unnecessary choice, adds friction

MERGE OR COMPRESS

- Problem Reframe section** — Compress to one callout paragraph inside Section 02. Move "30% less design time" to Outcomes
- Validation section metrics** — Move all metric numbers to Outcomes. Keep only the process story (Key Pivot + What we missed)

3. **System Foundations block** (Accessibility + Edge Cases cards) — Cut Accessibility card. Compress Edge Cases to 1 sentence in Reflection

FIX

1. **Research Section thumbnails** — Cards 2 and 3 both show the calculator screen; replace with the correct screens
2. **Stats grid label convention** — Standardize to all category labels or all first-person
3. **"44 components" vs "Existing library"** contradiction — Clarify with one sentence

What's Working Well (Don't Touch)

- **Hero headline** — "Up to 40% of that phone is just tax. We built the system that gives it back." Extremely strong.
- **5-challenge cards in Problem section** — Well-framed, specific, shows systems thinking
- **Design Exploration principles** — The bento grid with numbered principles is the best-designed section
- **HR Portal CSS mockup** — Genuinely impressive; recruiters will remember it
- **Reflection grid** — "Edge cases are the product" is a standout insight. This is what separates senior candidates.
- **Attribution Note in Outcomes** — Rare honesty about metric limitations. Keep it exactly as-is.
- **"What we missed" in Validation** — Honest about the lessor/seller portal gap; shows self-awareness

Ideal Page Flow After Cuts

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Intro (headline + description + pills + mockup) ↓ Stats grid (4 cells,
cleaned up – role, team, platforms, timeline) ↓ Problem (narrative + 5
challenges – no scope grid) ↓ Research (3 cards – fix thumbnails) ↓ Design
Exploration (5 principles + A/B concepts – fix 2.4x framing) ↓ Final Solution
(4-tab portals – remove carousel/grid toggle) ↓ Outcomes (6 metrics – merged
with Validation results, attribution note kept) ↓ Validation (process only – Key
Pivot + What we missed) ↓ Reflection (keep all 5 cards + reframe "Next
Iteration") ↓ [Back / Next Project button]

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This gets from 12 sections → 9 sections while removing all the redundancy and dead content.

Sources consulted: [UX Case Study Structure — uxfol.io](https://blog.uxfol.io/ux-case-study-structure/), [11 UX Portfolio Red Flags — UX Playbook] (https://uxplaybook.org/articles/11-common-ux-portfolio-mistakes-and-solutions), [IxDF: How to Write UX Case Studies](https://ixdf.org/literature/article/how-to-write-great-case-studies-for-your-ux-design-portfolio), [UX Portfolio for Senior Designers 2025 — UX Playbook](https://uxplaybook.org/articles/senior-ux-designer-portfolio-get-hired-2025)